UPSC Weekly Current Affairs

9 – 15 November 2026 · 9 top stories · 30 also important · Sources: PIB and The Hindu

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Top stories of the week

COP31: Can negotiators finally deliver results? | The Hindu explains

Wed 11 Nov · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology · GS2, GS3

• From catastrophic floods in Nepal to record-breaking heat, droughts and wildfires, the climate crisis is no longer a future threat.
• As world leaders gather in Antalya for COP31, the focus has shifted from promises to implementation.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.
• **Internal security:** Open border can be misused for trafficking, fake currency and movement of criminals; SSB guards it.
• **Economy:** Hydropower trade (India buys Nepali power), cross-border rail and petroleum pipelines.

Static connect: UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: COP31, Can, Hindu, From, Nepal

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/videos/cop31-can-negotiators-finally-deliver-results-the-hindu-ex

Trump says likely to meet Putin, Xi at China APEC summit

Tue 10 Nov · International Relations · GS2

• President Donald Trump indicated to reporters that a deal on the Russia-Ukraine war, the Iran issue and nuclear arms control would be on the agenda

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaputra (Yarlung Tsangpo).
• **Economy:** Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain diversification.
• **International relations:** Strategic competition in the Indian Ocean (String of Pearls), BRI vs connectivity alternatives (IMEC), and balancing via Quad while engaging in BRICS/SCO.

Static connect: APEC

• Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation, formed in 1989; 21 member economies around the Pacific Rim.
• India is not a member.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Trump, Putin, China APEC, President Donald Trump, Russia-Ukraine

Source: The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/us-china-russia-leaders-to-meet-next-week-says

Island fisheries at the centre of India’s Blue Economy push

Tue 10 Nov · Agriculture · GS3

• India is endowed with a vast and diverse marine resource base, supported by a coastline of approximately 11,099 km and an Exclusive Economic Zone of nearly 24 lakh sq.
• With an estimated marine fisheries potential of 58.6 lakh MT within its EEZ, the sector plays a vital role in sustaining the livelihoods of nearly 50 lakh fishers, while contributing significantly to food security, nutrition, employment, income…

Static connect: Blue Economy

• India's coastline is about 11,099 km (revised measurement) and its Exclusive Economic Zone about 2 million sq km.
• Schemes include PM Matsya Sampada Yojana and the Deep Ocean Mission.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Island, Blue Economy, Exclusive Economic Zone, EEZ

Source: PIB, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, 10 Nov 2026 · https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2334511

India reaffirms Commitment to Climate Multilateralism and a Fair, Ambitious Outcome at UNFCCC COP31, in Antalya (Türkiye)

Tue 10 Nov · Environment & Ecology · GS3

• India has reaffirmed its commitment to climate multilateralism and the principles of Equity and Common But Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC), calling for a fair, equitable and ambitious outcome at the 31st Conference of the Parties (COP31) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), being held in Antalya, Türkiye.
• Delivering India's Opening Statement at…

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Static connect: UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Commitment, Climate Multilateralism, Fair, Ambitious Outcome, UNFCCC COP31

Source: PIB, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, 10 Nov 2026 · https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2334571

ED attaches properties in Kashmir in ‘misuse’ of PM Employment Generation Programme scheme case

Tue 10 Nov · Governance & Social Justice, Economy · GS2, GS3

• An ED spokesman said there was misappropriation of PMEGP Scheme’s loans in criminal conspiracy with the PMEGP borrowers, bank officials of Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch of J&K Bank and other unknown persons

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Infiltration, hybrid terrorists and narco-terror links; normalcy indicators such as tourism and voter turnout.
• **Governance & polity:** After the abrogation of Article 370 (2019, upheld by the Supreme Court in 2023), questions of statehood restoration and Sixth Schedule demands in Ladakh.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Kashmir, PM Employment Generation Programme, PMEGP Scheme, PMEGP, Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch

Source: The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jammu-and-kashmir/ed-attaches-properties-in-kashmir

Cyber bullying affects one in ten students worldwide; AI fuels new threat: UNESCO

Tue 10 Nov · International Relations, Science & Technology · GS1, GS2, GS3

• The United Nations agency has called upon countries to invest in digital safety measures, teacher preparation, and mental health support for students, in coordination with technology companies

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Cyber attacks on critical infrastructure and fraud like 'digital arrest' scams; CERT-In, NCIIPC and I4C are the response agencies.
• **Governance & polity:** IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and the need for cyber hygiene and capacity in state police.
• **Science & tech:** IndiaAI Mission (2024) for compute, datasets and indigenous models; India hosted the AI Impact Summit in 2026.
• **Ethics:** Deepfakes, bias, privacy and accountability call for responsible-AI rules and platform obligations under the IT Rules.

Static connect: UNESCO lists

• World Heritage under the 1972 Convention; Intangible Cultural Heritage under the 2003 Convention.
• UNESCO also runs the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) programme and Global Geoparks.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cyber, UNESCO, United Nations

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/cyber-bullying-affects-one-in-ten-students-worldw

Supreme Court terms vehicular emissions major contributor to air pollution in Delhi-NCR

Tue 10 Nov · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology · GS2, GS3

• The Bench highlighted the large number of vehicles plying on roads connecting Delhi with neighbouring areas, including Ghaziabad, Greater Noida, Gurugram and Faridabad

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Governance & polity:** Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.
• **Society:** Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.
• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Static connect: Air quality governance

• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Supreme Court, Delhi-NCR, Bench, Delhi, Ghaziabad

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-terms-vehicular-emissions-major-contr

Poland arrests two Ukrainians over alleged Russian espionage, sabotage

Wed 11 Nov · International Relations · GS2

• Poland has long ■accused Russia and its ally Belarus of waging a hybrid campaign involving sabotage, cyberattacks ■and disinformation since Moscow’s 2022 invasion of Ukraine

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **International relations:** India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.
• **Economy:** Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.
• **Internal security:** Dependence on Russian defence equipment (S-400, Su-30) and the push for indigenisation (Atmanirbhar Bharat in defence).
• **Governance & polity:** IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and the need for cyber hygiene and capacity in state police.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Poland, Ukrainians, Russian, Russia, Belarus

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/poland-arrests-two-ukrainians-over-alleged-rus

Govt. prohibits export of unsorted lithium-ion battery waste, scrap

Wed 11 Nov · Geography, Polity & Constitution · GS1, GS2, GS3

• The Government of India has prohibited the export of unsorted lithium-ion battery waste and scrap.
• Earlier classified under the 'Free' category, the move aims to retain critical battery material within the country for recycling.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

Securing lithium and other critical minerals is central to India's electric mobility and energy storage targets amid heavy reliance on imports.
• **Economy:** Incentivizes indigenous recycling capacities and protects supply chains from global supply shocks.
• **Environment:** Fosters a circular economy by diverting toxic e-waste into secondary raw material extraction.
• **International relations:** Reduces external vulnerabilities to foreign monopolies controlling the processing and refining of battery raw materials.

Static connect: Critical Minerals Policy in India

• The Ministry of Mines identified 30 critical minerals essential for economic development and national security.
• Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022 mandate Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) targets for recovery and recycling of battery materials.

Prelims pointers

• Export policy notifications for commodities are issued by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
• Lithium is designated as a critical and strategic mineral under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2023.

Mains angle

Discuss the significance of retaining critical mineral waste in bolstering India's domestic battery recycling ecosystem and energy transition (GS Paper III - Economic Development & Industrial Policy).

Practice question

Examine the strategic and ecological necessity of developing a domestic circular economy for critical minerals. In this context, assess the impact of recent restrictions on the export of battery scrap.

Source: The Hindu, National, 11 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/business/govt-prohibits-export-of-unsorted-lithium-ion-batterywas

Also important this week

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

• **Heat-trapping carbon pollution drops, but scientists cite Iran war rather than energy progress** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)

In 2026, the world emitted 42.2 billion tonne of heat-trapping carbon dioxide from the burning of fossil fuels such as coal, oil and gas.

Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

• **A case for Nepal: suing major carbon emitters for floods** (The Hindu, Environment, 09 Nov 2026)

While climate wrongs harm society, they do not harm individuals in a sufficiently direct and proximate way

Why it matters **International relations**: Open border under the 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship; map dispute over Kalapani–Lipulekh–Limpiyadhura; competition with Chinese investment.; **Internal security**: Open border can be misused for trafficking, fake currency and movement of criminals; SSB guards it.

• **COP31 opens as climate and geopolitical pressures mount** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)

More than 100,000 people are expected to attend COP31 in a sprawling expo centre in the Mediterranean seaside city of Antalya over the next two weeks

Why it matters **Environment**: India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.; **International relations**: India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

• **Supreme Court goes beyond Deepavali AQI, flags vehicular emissions polluting Delhi air** (The Hindu, Environment, 10 Nov 2026)
The court says Delhi and the NCR bear the ‘cumulative burden of vehicular traffic’ and seeks to know what has been done to regulate in the capital the entry and plying of vehicles from neighbouring States
Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.; **Society**: Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

• **Delhi's air quality improves to 'poor' due to increased wind speed** (The Hindu, Health, 10 Nov 2026)
On Monday, the day after Diwali, the capital's average Air Quality Index (AQI) stood at 376, in the 'very poor' category.
Why it matters **Environment**: Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.; **Governance & polity**: Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.

GEOGRAPHY

• **Trump to meet Iran war mediator Qatar, no imminent deal seen to end war** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
Mutual attacks continue, with the U.S.
Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Strait of Hormuz LNG traffic hits highest in October since Iran war began** (The Hindu, Economy, 10 Nov 2026)
October exports ■were ■the highest since February when the war ■started and were up from September’s corresponding tally of 23 vessels exiting the strait
Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

• **Oil falls as Donald Trump says new Iran attacks ‘unlikely’** (The Hindu, Economy, 09 Nov 2026)
On November 8, 2026, ■Iraq reached an understanding with the U.S.
Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Trump says resumption of war with Iran 'highly unlikely'** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
Iran continues to at least partly block traffic through the strategic Strait of Hormuz, which has dented oil supplies out of the Gulf.
Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **NMDC said to be in talks with Russia’s Rosatom over lithium investments** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
Rosatom and Russian miner Nornickel, however, are developing the country’s largest lithium deposit through their PolarLithium joint venture, with commercial production expected to begin by 2030
Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

• **NMC cautions students against fake medical colleges, asks them to verify approvals** (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
The advisory follows the Supreme Court taking cognisance of the issue in an ongoing case in which the court directed regulatory bodies, including the National Medical Commission, to caution students and parents against dealing with unauthorised educational ins
Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.; **Society**: Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

• **Deepavali pollution spike: How does it affect lung function and respiratory health? | Explained** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)
Firecracker smoke releases fine particles and harmful gases that irritate the airways and affect lung health.
Why it matters **Environment**: Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.; **Governance & polity**: Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.

• **China says 2026 trade surplus surpassed $1 trillion in October** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
Exports from the world's second-largest economy have surged in recent months, driven in part by soaring global demand for artificial intelligence-related products including computer chips, data centre servers and networking equipment
Why it matters **Internal security**: Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaput; **Economy**: Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain d

• **Trump says FBI looking into Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's affair with 'Chinese agent'** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
The sudden emergence of Nvidia CEO Huang's infidelity has created concerns about whether China has been able to access the cutting-edge chips designed by Nvidia that are powering the development of artificial intelligence
Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **India’s efforts to clean its air need not slow its economic growth** (The Hindu, Science, 11 Nov 2026)
Highlights the need to decouple air pollution mitigation from economic slowdown through targeted developmental interventions.
Why it matters **Environment**: Emphasizes targeted sectoral interventions over blunt industrial bans to lower PM2.5 and PM10 levels.; **Economy**: Promoting clean cooking and industrial efficiency avoids productivity losses linked to poor health and fossil-fuel dependence.

• **NCAHP Proposes New Registration Framework to Strengthen Allied and Healthcare Professions in India** (PIB, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, 11 Nov 2026)
National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) under MoHFW proposed a regulatory framework for provisional registration of allied health professionals.
Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Institutionalizes qualifications and establishes transparency through centralized registration databases.; **Society**: Improves healthcare service delivery quality in secondary and tertiary care by eliminating quackery.

HISTORY & ART AND CULTURE

• **Cyclone Murasu: Heavy rain and power cuts dampen spirit of Deepavali** (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
Heavy downpour and power cuts have dampened the festival spirit among everyone, right from kids to elderly people and farmers to retail vendors
Why it matters **Geography & disasters**: India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.; **Governance & polity**: Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

• **Fisherfolk seek higher compensation for men who died in Murasu cyclone** (The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026)
Neithal Makkal Katchi’s K.
Why it matters **Geography & disasters**: India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.; **Governance & polity**: Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

INDIAN SOCIETY

• **Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan at Six** (PIB, PIB Backgrounder, 11 Nov 2026)
Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan (NMBA) completed six years; initially rolled out in 272 vulnerable districts in 2020, it was expanded nationwide in 2023.
Why it matters **Society**: Mobilizes women and youth networks to de-stigmatize addiction treatment and encourage early intervention.; **Internal security**: Drives demand reduction, complementing law enforcement crackdowns on illicit cross-border narcotics trafficking.

INTERNAL SECURITY

• Israeli forces shoot dead 14-year-old in West Bank: Palestinian officials (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
The Israeli military, asked by AFP about the incident, said on Tuesday (November 10, 2026) it had acted to "thwart stone-hurling and terrorist attacks" in the area.

Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

• G7 Ministers meet on efforts to end Ukraine conflict, halt new Iran war (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
Ministers from the leading industrialised nations of Britain, Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and the United States will be gathering with preoccupations strikingly similar to those of the last such meeting in March

Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

• Tens of thousands march in Amsterdam, pressing Dutch government on Gaza, Israel (The Hindu, International, 08 Nov 2026)
Organisers of the “Red Line” demonstration called for stricter trade sanctions, a halt to arms sales, and an official declaration that Israel’s actions in Gaza amount to genocide

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• Past talks involving Russia and Ukraine have yielded little progress toward peace (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
Key developments from past sessions since Moscow's full-scale invasion of its neighbor on Feb.

Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

• Himalayas agenda left off COP31 formal list as major blocs withhold support: Nepal Foreign Minister (The Hindu, International, 11 Nov 2026)
The dedicated agenda on the Himalayan ecosystem was excluded from the COP31 formal negotiations list due to lack of support from major geopolitical blocs.

Why it matters **International relations**: Underscores divergence between major geopolitical blocs and vulnerable mountain nations regarding climate negotiation priorities.; **Environment**: Risks delaying global adaptation finance and monitoring frameworks essential to avert Himalayan glacial retreat.

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

• Postpone panchayat, municipal elections to April-May next year: Ladakh group (The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026)
“We suspect that this government is up to some mischief.

Why it matters **Internal security**: Infiltration, hybrid terrorists and narco-terror links; normalcy indicators such as tourism and voter turnout.; **Governance & polity**: After the abrogation of Article 370 (2019, upheld by the Supreme Court in 2023), questions of statehood restoration and Sixth Schedule demands in Ladakh.

• Commercial cultivation within forest land not protected under FRA, 2006: Supreme Court (The Hindu, Environment, 09 Nov 2026)
Says FRA protects forest-dwelling communities dependent on forests for generations, not commercial cultivators and plantation owners

Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.; **Society**: Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

• **New Israeli parliament to take aim at Netanyahu as Eisenkot seeks government** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
President Isaac Herzog, ceremonially opening the session, called on all sides to work together and avoid a fresh election in a deeply polarised country weary from three years of war.
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REPORTS & INDICES

• **Keralam measles outbreaks call for a relook at disease epidemiology** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)
Once predominantly a childhood disease affecting children aged one to five, measles is now being reported across age groups, including among fully vaccinated individuals and infants below nine months, who are not yet eligible for routine measles vaccination
Why it matters **Society**: Public health outcomes and out-of-pocket spending; schemes like Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY and the TB-elimination target.; **Governance & polity**: Health is a State subject; centre–state coordination and the One Health approach for disease surveillance.

• **World entering 'age of climate extremes': UN chief** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
The UN chief statement came as the UN's World Meteorological Organization released a report indicating that 2026 has continued a streak of exceptional global temperatures, melting ice and rising sea levels
Why it matters **Environment**: India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.; **International relations**: India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

• **How AI is reshaping China's universities** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
AI disruption and a tightening job market are driving a sweeping change across China's universities; under the government's 'guideline on the reform of higher education institutions', universities will now be tasked with specific goals, pursuing either researc
Why it matters **Internal security**: Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaputra; **Economy**: Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain d

Prelims quick revision

• Export policy notifications for commodities are issued by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
• Lithium is designated as a critical and strategic mineral under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2023.
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) targets reduction in PM2.5 and PM10 concentrations across non-attainment cities.
• The Himalayas are known as the 'Third Pole' due to holding the largest concentration of ice and snow outside the polar regions.
• The National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions Act was enacted in 2021 under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
• Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan is an initiative of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.
• National Action Plan for Drug Demand Reduction (NAPDDR) provides financial assistance for de-addiction, rehabilitation, and preventive awareness.
• In entire India 13 crore voters were dropped from the voter list.
• Ladakh is a small region and fraud is easy," said Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA) chairman Tsering Dorjey Lakrook

Static topics that came up this week

UNFCCC & Paris Agreement

• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.

APEC
• Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation, formed in 1989; 21 member economies around the Pacific Rim.
• India is not a member.

Blue Economy
• India's coastline is about 11,099 km (revised measurement) and its Exclusive Economic Zone about 2 million sq km.
• Schemes include PM Matsya Sampada Yojana and the Deep Ocean Mission.

UNESCO lists
• World Heritage under the 1972 Convention; Intangible Cultural Heritage under the 2003 Convention.
• UNESCO also runs the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) programme and Global Geoparks.

Air quality governance
• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.

Critical Minerals Policy in India
• The Ministry of Mines identified 30 critical minerals essential for economic development and national security.
• Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022 mandate Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) targets for recovery and recycling of battery materials.

National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)
• Launched in 2019 by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).
• Aims for a 40% reduction in PM concentrations by 2026 across non-attainment cities compared to 2017 levels.

Qeshm Island (Iran)
• Largest island in the Persian Gulf, in Iran's Hormozgan province, across from the port of Bandar Abbas.
• Lies at the Strait of Hormuz; nearby islands: Hormuz, Larak, Kish; Abu Musa and the Greater/Lesser Tunbs are disputed between Iran and the UAE.
• Known for the Hara mangrove forests and a free trade zone.

Strait of Hormuz
• Connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
• Lies between Iran (north) and Oman's Musandam peninsula (south).
• Major chokepoint for crude oil and LNG exports from the Gulf, including a large part of India's energy imports.

G7
• US, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and Canada, with the EU taking part; India is often invited as an outreach partner.

Gaza Strip
• Narrow Palestinian territory on the Mediterranean coast, bordering Israel and Egypt (Rafah crossing).
• India's long-standing position supports a two-state solution.

Hindu Kush Himalaya (HKH) Region
• Spans across 8 countries including India, Nepal, Bhutan, and China.
• Sources 10 major river basins, supporting over 1.9 billion people downstream.

National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions Act, 2021
• Regulates education and practice of allied and healthcare professionals across designated categories.
• Mandates maintaining Central and State registers of registered professionals.

National Action Plan for Drug Demand Reduction (NAPDDR)
• Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.
• Focuses on a multi-pronged strategy involving preventive education, treatment, and socio-economic integration of rehabilitated individuals.

Critical minerals
• The Centre has notified a list of critical minerals and launched the National Critical Mineral Mission (2025).
• KABIL (Khanij Bidesh India Ltd) secures overseas mineral assets.